



BEMSTS EMS & Trauma Portal Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Accessing the EMS & Trauma Portal

I had an account in the old EMS Portal. Can I access my existing information in the new EMS & Trauma Portal without creating a new account?

Individuals who had accounts in the old EMS Portal can access their existing information by claiming an account in the new EMS & Trauma Portal. To claim an account, go to ems.azdhs.gov, click "Forgot Username," and enter the information requested.

1. Click "Forgot Username."

Login

Username

Password ☐ Show Password

[Forgot Username or Forgot Password?](#)

[Login](#) [Create Account](#)

2. Enter your Date of Birth, Last Name, and the Email Address associated with your old EMS Portal account.

Forgot Username

Search for your username by entering the following information:

*Date of Birth:

*Last Name:

*Email:

[Lookup](#) [Back](#)

3. Your username will be sent to the email address provided. Please check your email to obtain your username and instructions to reset your password.

How do I create an account in the new EMS & Trauma Portal?

To create an account, follow the steps below:

1. Go to ems.azdhs.gov (EMCTs, Ambulance Providers, and Training Centers) or emshospitals.azdhs.gov (Trauma Centers and Base Hospitals).
2. Click "Create Account."

Login

Username

Password ☐ Show Password

[Forgot Username or Forgot Password?](#)

[Login](#) [Create Account](#)

3. Fill out the demographics, address, and contact information sections. Fields with an asterisk are required.

4. Click "Save" to complete this form. You will be redirected to the homepage and receive instructions to check your email to obtain your username.
5. Follow the instructions to reset your password.

My email address changed. What should I do?

If the email address you provided when creating an account is no longer active or you no longer have access to it, you are required to send an email to Maria.Dominguez@azdhs.gov or Kathleen.Rodriguez@azdhs.gov to request that your email address be updated. Please provide the spelling of your first and last name, date of birth and the last four digits of your social security number as verification. In addition, please provide your new email address. It is the responsibility of the EMCTs to keep all of their information updated.

What Browser should be used for the EMS & Trauma Portal?

Our system will work well with latest browser versions of:

- Google Chrome
- Mozilla Firefox
- Microsoft Edge
- Apple Safari

Can mobile devices be used to create an online application in the EMS & Trauma Portal?

YES. Keep in mind that using mobile devices may make navigating through the system difficult.

Initial EMCT Certification

Once I complete and pass the initial course, test and pass National Registry, do I create a new account even though I have a Trainee Account?

NO. You will use the same EMS & Trauma Portal account for your Trainee Account and your EMCT Account. To submit an initial application, you will login to your EMS & Trauma Portal account and follow the steps for NREMT Verification and Initial Application.

PLEASE NOTE: If your training program has not entered the scores for the course completed, the system will **not** allow you to create an initial application. The training programs have up to ten (10) business days to enter the scores after the course has ended. If it has been more than ten (10) business days and your scores have not been entered, please contact your training program and ask to have your scores entered.

What is a "Public Benefit Eligibility" document?

A photo of your Arizona Driver License, birth certificate or a United States Passport as proof of your legal presence in the United States. A list of the "Public Benefit Eligibility" will be available to you when you begin to create your application.

Does an employer letter satisfy the citizenship ("Public Benefit Eligibility") requirement?

YES. The Bureau has reviewed the list of eligibility documents and will allow a letter from your employer verifying U.S. citizenship or national status and eligibility to work in the United States if the letter contains all of the following: (1) date (2) a signature by an authorized representative of the company (3) the applicant's full name (4) printed on the employer's letterhead (5) the employer attests that the applicant is an employee and (6) the letter states the employer has verified your lawful presence in the United States

and eligibility to receive state or local public benefits as required by Federal and State statutes.

EMCT Recertification

What do I need to recertify as an EMCT?

EMCTs can recertify with any of the four options listed below:

1. Current CPR card mirroring AHA and accepted by their agency (Competency Based) and:
2. 24-hour traditional refresher using the content from a National Certification organization (Includes 150 question written exam and Practical skills tests).
3. Arizona Challenge Examination with questions on the content from the above refresher.
4. Current National Registry.
5. 24 hours of continuing education (CEs) mirroring the content of a traditional refresher course.
EMTs can use this option **only if they have worked 240 hours** as an EMT during their 2-year certification cycle. If an EMT has not worked 240 hours, they must recertify their certification using one of the options listed above.

Advanced-EMTs, Intermediate-99s and Paramedics can recertify with any of the four options listed below:

1. Current CPR card and a current ACLS card mirroring AHA and accepted by their agency (CPR & ACLS competency based) and 48-hour traditional refresher using the content from a National Certification organization to include 150 question written exam and practical skills test.
2. 48 hours of continuing education (CEs) mirroring the content of a traditional refresher course.
3. Arizona Challenge Examination with questions on the content from the above refresher.
4. Current National Registry.

Where do I document I have met my Continuing Medical Education requirements?

There is no documentation attachment feature when submitting an application. Applicants only attest that they have obtained the required Continuing Medical Education hours, are current with CPR and/or ACLS certifications and will maintain the documentation for three (3) years. This attestation appears in the application screens under the "Educational Attestation" section. All you have to do is click on the "Edit Educational Attestation" button and select the BLS & CPR option for EMTs or ALS with CPR and ACLS certificate attestation for Advanced-EMTs and Paramedics.

Will the EMS & Trauma Portal allow an EMCT to submit a Renewal application more than 90 days prior to expiration date?

NO. The system will only allow you to submit a Renewal application if you are 90 days or less, prior to the expiration date of your certification. You will receive reminder notices via email and through your EMCT account reminding you that you are up for renewal. The system will send a notice at 90, 60 and 30 days prior to your certification expiring. Renewal applications must be submitted prior to your certification expiring.

PLEASE NOTE: If you do not submit your application by the end of your expiration date your certification expires and you will be required to pay a **non-refundable** extension fee in the amount of **\$150.00** to renew your certification within 30 days after your certification has expired. ****

Can I apply for an extension if I am not able to meet my renewal requirements on time?

You get an automatic 30-day extension; however, you are required to pay a non-refundable extension fee in the amount of \$150.00 to recertify your certification no more than 30 days after the expiration date. The extension cycle is good for thirty (30) calendar days.

What happens if I am not able to renew until after the 30-day extension period?

Your certification will then become inactive. Once your certification becomes inactive, you are **NOT** allowed to work as an EMCT until you regain certification. You will be required to apply as an "initial" applicant and if you do not have a current National Registry certification, you will be required to obtain it prior to applying for Arizona certification.

Once your certification becomes inactive, your certification record will be archived and you will be assigned a new certification number once you meet all of the requirements for certification.

*******IMPORTANT*******

Do not continue working as an EMCT. By working as an EMCT without Arizona certification, you will be in violation of R9-25-401(A) which states, "An individual shall not act as an EMCT unless the individual has current certification or recertification from the Department."

If I become ill or a family member becomes ill or if I am in the military and will be deployed and I am not able to meet the recertification requirements on time, can I apply for an extension?

YES. You can apply online for a 180-day extension by logging in to your EMCT account and submitting an Extension Application. The 180-day extension application is for military service, authorized federal, state emergency response, deployment, personal or family illness.

- For military deployment or emergency response deployment, deployment orders are required to be submitted with the extension application.
- For personal or family illness, the EMCT would be eligible for one extension of time per certification cycle to file for recertification for no more than 180 days upon receipt of a written explanation.

Upgrading & Downgrading EMCT Certification

How do I upgrade my certification from EMT to Advanced-EMT or Paramedic?

EMTs can upgrade their certification with a higher-level National Registry certification and by submitting an upgrade application by logging in to their EMCT account.

How do I downgrade my certification from Advanced-EMT or Paramedic to EMT?

1. You will be required to submit a downgrade application with a written statement from your administrative medical director attesting that the EMCT is able to perform at the lower EMCT classification level requested. The statement must be on the agency's letterhead and must be dated and signed by the medical director; **OR**
2. If applying for continued certification as an EMT, an Arizona EMT refresher course certificate of completion or an Arizona EMT refresher challenge examination certificate signed by the training program director designated for the Arizona EMT refresher course; **OR**

3. Recertification at a lower EMCT classification level by completing an EMT refresher course or EMT challenge exam or with documentation of current registration in a national certification organization at a higher level of EMCT classification. Example, you can use your National Registry certification at the Paramedic or Advanced-EMT level to recertify at the EMT level.

General Certification Questions

If an EMCT is relocating from another state to Arizona, what is needed to become Arizona certified? Can my certification be transferred to Arizona?

Arizona does not have reciprocal agreements with any other states; therefore, you cannot transfer your certification to Arizona. You are required to have a current and valid National Registry certification and an Arizona address. Arizona will not certify anyone initially at any level if they do not have a current and valid National Registry certification.

Bureau policy prescribes that only applicants with an Arizona address are eligible for Arizona certification. The Bureau will not process applications with an out-of-state address. If you are employed by an agency based in Arizona, you may register with the agency's address; otherwise, you may register once you have an Arizona address as required in Arizona Statutes and Rules. This pertains to individuals applying for initial or recertification.

I am considering/have moved from Arizona to another state and have a verification form that needs to be filled out by the state of Arizona. Can I email it to the Bureau to have it filled out and sent to the state requesting the verification of certification?

YES. You can send a scanned copy to Angie.McNamara@azdhs.gov to be completed. Include your date of birth and the last 4 numbers of your social security for identification purposes only. Please make sure you complete your portion of the form.

What is National Registry's (NREMT) phone number? What is National Registry's (NREMT) website address?

Toll Free: (614) 888-4484

www.nremt.org

Does Arizona charge for certification?

No, Arizona does not charge for EMCT certification.

Once an application is submitted, how long will it take to be processed?

Please allow at least five (5) to ten (10) business days for your application to be reviewed and processed.

After my application is approved, will a certification card be mailed to me? How do I view and print my certification card?

NO. As of July 1, 2021, the Bureau implemented a completely digital certification process and is no longer printing certification cards. You will be able to access and print your electronic certification card by following the steps below:

1. Login to your EMCT Portal by going to ems.azdhs.gov.
2. Once logged in, click "Applications" on the left toolbar in your account.
3. Click "Apply" next to the Application titled "Generate Certification Card for Active EMCT."
4. You will be able to access your EMCT card immediately by clicking on "Documents" under "My

Account."

5. You will also receive an email from "noreply@azdhs.gov" with a copy of your EMCT card.

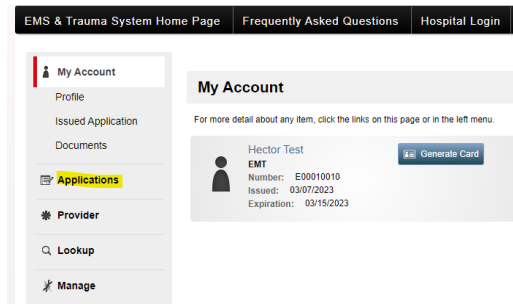
Can I save a digital copy of my electronic certification on my cell phone?

Yes. You can save a screenshot of your electronic certificate and save the image to your phone by following the steps below:

1. Login to your EMCT Portal by going to ems.azdhs.gov.
2. Follow the steps above to generate your EMCT card.
3. Now that the electronic certification is displayed, take a screenshot of the electronic certificate and save the image to the photograph section on your cell phone for quick access.

How can I upload a photo on my electronic certification?

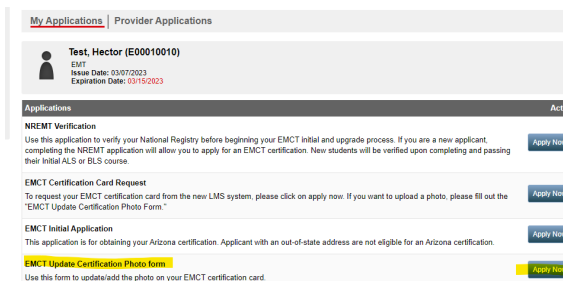
1. Login to your EMCT Portal by going to ems.azdhs.gov.
2. Once logged in, click on **"Applications"** located on the left side column.



3. Click the **"View My Applications"** button.

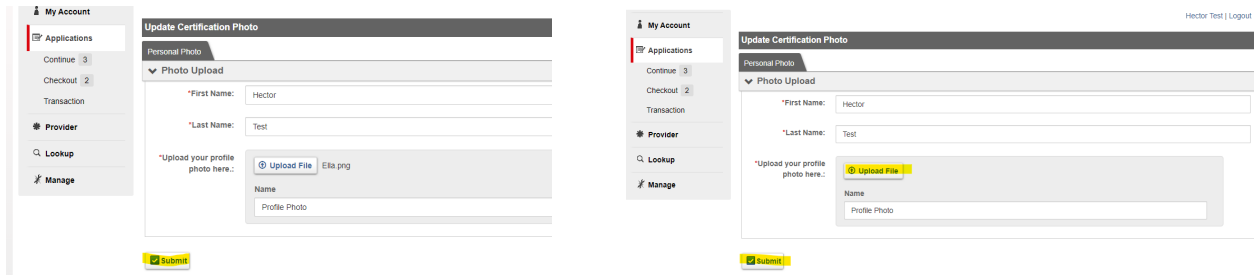


4. Select **"EMCT Update Certification Photo Form"** and click **"Apply Now."**



5. Click on **"Upload File"** and click on **"Choose File"** to upload your photo and click **"Save."**





6. Once you have selected and saved your photo, click **“Submit.”**

****Attention**** Please ensure the uploaded photo is appropriate for an official ID card. No sunglasses or hats. The photo should be of you and not include any other individual. The photo should be taken from your shoulders up and leave space above the hairline (similar to a Driver’s License or State Identification card). Additionally, please ensure your photo’s dimensions are 150 pixels.

How can I edit the dimensions of my photo to 150 pixels?

1. On your computer, go to the location where the photo is saved. Place the cursor over the photo and right click.
2. Select **“Edit.”**
3. Select **“Resize.”**
4. Select **“Pixels.”**
5. Go to **“Horizontal”** and enter 150 Step 6: click **“Save.”**

How can I rotate my photo to a vertical position if it’s saved in a horizontal position?

1. On your computer, go to the location where the photo is saved. Place the cursor over the photo and right click.
2. Select **“Edit.”**
3. Select **“Rotate”** and adjust the positioning of your photo until it is in the vertical position.
4. Click **“Save.”**

How do I update my name in the EMS & Trauma Portal if I get married or divorced?

To update your name, you are required to create and submit an “Applicant Name Change” application with a document that proves the legal name change. Documents accepted as legal proof of name change are:

- Marriage Certificate
- Social Security Card
- Driver’s License
- Divorce Decree (Only the page showing you changed your last name back to your maiden name should be uploaded.)

When uploading a document as part of the application process, what type of document is best to upload with the system? PDF, JPEG or JPG documents upload better with the system.

In the online profile, does the EMCT's certification number show to the public?

YES. The certification number is not protected information and is important information for employers or future employers to verify the certification status.

Has the Bureau confirmed that the last 4 digits or any part of the social security number is not revealed on the public or coordinator pages?

YES. The Bureau has reviewed the screen display of a coordinator role and public views confirming that the "Detail Tab" which contains the date of birth and social security number are not displaying.

Organizations

How many organizations can an EMCT select?

Each EMCT can select one primary organization and unlimited secondary organizations.

Can the organization coordinator remove an EMCT's affiliation to that organization?

Yes. The organization coordinator can add and remove an EMCT's affiliation to their organization.

How do I set up multiple coordinator accounts for an organization?

To designate an individual as a coordinator, contact the Bureau of EMS and Trauma System.

If my organization is not available to select, how do I have the Bureau add it to the list of organizations on the online database system?

If your organization does not seem to appear on the list, there is a possibility that it is on the list under another name. To add your organization to the selection list, contact your Bureau Coordinator as indicated below:

Training Programs	Air & Ground Ambulances	Trauma Centers & Base Hospitals
Thomas.Mackay@azdhs.gov	Margo.Vinson@azdhs.gov Steven.Foster@azdhs.gov Dewey.Anderson@azdhs.gov Stephen.Ferris@azdhs.gov Russell.Lindholm@azdhs.gov	Kimberly.Boehm@azdhs.gov Marissa.Salgado@azdhs.gov

If an organization's name is spelled wrong or listed more than once, who do I contact at the Bureau for corrections?

To correct misspelled or duplicate CON names, contact Brian Hubbell, CON and Rates Program Manager, at brian.hubbell@azdhs.gov.

Does the system allow multiple roles?

Yes. If you have an EMCT and an Organizational Coordinator account both roles will show when you log into your EMCT account. You only need one login and you can add the contact information for your Organizational Coordinator account.

How do I add or change my “Organizational Assignments”?

Due to the design of the security features for the system, you must contact one of the Customer Service Representatives with the Bureau at 602-364-3150 or toll free at 1-800-200-8523 and inform them you need to make a change to your organizational assignment.

I volunteer or provide EMCT services for multiple EMS organizations and I was asked by my Medical Direction to indicate they are my Base Hospital as well. Can I have more than one organizational assignment associated with my certification?

YES, if you have already activated your account and selected your organization assignments, you must contact one of the Customer Service Representatives at the Bureau by emailing Maria.Dominguez@azdhs.gov or Kathleen.Rodriguez@azdhs.gov they will update your organizational assignment.

Are the coordinators approved by the organization before the Bureau approves the individual?

The coordinators currently listed for an organization were already established with the Bureau. If the organization is not a Bureau regulated entity, an authorized agent of that organization needs to submit a letter to the Bureau indicating approval for a specific coordinator

Training & Education

What is the difference between a Trainee Vs EMCT when selecting an account role as a student?

A Trainee is an individual who does not have Arizona certification and wishes to enroll in an Arizona Training Program. Trainee students cannot be added to the training program course until they have submitted a Trainee Account application. An EMCT is an individual who has Arizona certification, whether expired, inactive, or pre-registered, and wishes to enroll in an Arizona Training Program. EMCTs that have a status other than “Active” need to activate an account to allow a training program to enter the EMCT into a course.

How can we tell if our scores have been entered?

You must login to your account and look at your profile. You should have a “Training” tab attached to your profile. Click on the “Training” tab; if your scores are entered there should be a “Result” tab. If there is no “Result” tab, this means your scores have not been entered. Contact your training program and let them know your scores have not been entered; otherwise, the system will not allow you to create an application.

What if there is no “Training” tab attached to my profile after completing the course?

Then your training program has not attached you to the electronic course roster. Contact the training program and have them attach you to the electronic roster and enter your scores. Before contacting the training program, make sure you are registered as a “Trainee” and not as an “EMCT,” and that you have affiliated yourself to the training program; otherwise, the instructor will not find you in the database to attach you to the course roster. In this case, you must contact the Bureau and speak to one of the Customer Service Representatives to assist you in correcting your account prior to contacting the training program.

Where can I find a list of the training programs to enroll in a course?

To find a list of available training programs, go to

<https://www.azdhs.gov/preparedness/emergency-medical-services-trauma-system/index.php#education-upcoming-courses>. Please note that the Advanced EMT course is not currently available in Arizona.

Criminal Convictions

If I have a criminal conviction that occurred within the timelines specified in the application, what court documents do I have to provide?

When you initially apply for certification or recertification, you will need to submit a legible copy of the court order (often called a judgment and sentencing order) that shows the offense(s) that you were convicted of, the date of the conviction, and the terms of the sentence that was imposed by the court.

Depending on the nature of the conviction, your application may be assigned to the Enforcement and Compliance Section for further review, and an Investigator may send you a written request for additional information. If the Department sends such a request, it cannot process your application further until all of the requested information is provided.

How long does information about disciplinary action remain on the Department of Health website?

Adverse actions against an EMCT remain on the EMCT’s public profile for a period of five years after the date of the action. After 5 years, the notice of adverse action is automatically removed from the EMCT’s public profile. However, the Department may be required by law to maintain internal records of investigations for a longer period of time, and these records may be subject to public records requests. Additionally, the Department is required to report many adverse actions to the U.S. Department of Health & Human Services’s National Practitioner Data Bank, a repository of records for health care providers. The NPDB record may be retained even after the Arizona adverse action is removed from the EMCT’s profile.

**Contact the Bureau’s main number during normal business hours, Monday – Friday,
8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, excluding state holidays and weekends at 602-364-3150, option #0
if your question has not been answered.**